

Tab 1

Description:

Eyes: One is a deep purple and the other is gray

Hair: lavender

Skin: pale (like ember)

Scars down her arms and back

Family:

Her dad is a nobleman

She has demon ancestry (obviously) on her mothers side, and they didn't know. Her parents had a "successful" child before her and her mother was *horrified* when she was born with faint purple hair, horn nubs, and a tail. They never tried to have another child because she was considered such an abomination

She grew up kinda exiled, kept out of the view of the public, left at home for events, locked in her room when the family hosted. (Until she was sixteen)

Her mom died when she was really young((four)) (it's said Hycinthia did it but she has no memories of it.)

Her brother was nine when she died, and after that year he started being sent to a boarding school

Around her being sixteen her father started bringing her out, (her tail was hidden in her skirts and horns were hidden somehow) and her brother stopped coming home.

She started learning how to manage the (legal) trade, and helping her dad by organizing the ledgers

At eighteen she was sent on a ship to a festival in another continent to manage the trades herself and got shipwrecked (wherever she meets the party)

The Awakening

Age Four.

She could hear yelling from down the hall; her parents always fought. The shouting grew louder, and she cowered behind a curtain, clutching her tail like a lifeline. They were yelling about her; it was always about her. She sank further into the curtain, wishing she knew where Percival was. He'd always known what to do when they yelled.

"She's a monster, Jonathan," her mother's voice echoed through the hall. The silence that followed was almost deafening. Hycinthia stood in her corner, her heart pounding. Quietly, she walked toward their door and gently pushed it open, slipping through the crack.

"Mama," she said, her voice so quiet that it was hardly above a whisper. Her tail curled around her like a hug. She looked up at her, her eyes swelling.

"Hycinthia, get out." His voice was so stern and sharp that she burst into tears.

"Mama," she said again, wanting to make it better, to fix the fight, but her mother wouldn't look at her. Lorelei's eyes were locked on Jonathan's.

"You," she said, her voice measured, "Are nothing more than a coward." She gripped a knife, sliding it from the table, and threw it at Hycinthia. It sunk into her side as she stumbled backward into her father. He stepped over her, grabbing his wife's arms as she lunged with another knife, trying to hold her back from his daughter.

"Lorelei," he said, his voice equally measured, but Hycinthia didn't hear the rest. She curled in on herself from the pain, clinging to herself.

"Mama," she said softly, her voice a whimper as the pain consumed her. Blood pooled around her, soaking her white dress, covering her hands as she grabbed for the pain, not understanding. She pulled the knife from her body, causing the blood to gush from her wound. Her vision started fuzzing as golden lines appeared around her, strings stemming from her body and onto the floor. She reached for one and tugged as her mother cut into her again, slashing wildly. It hit her outstretched arm as she pulled, but Hycinthia's fist was tight on the line. Her blood shot up in a wall, cutting through the air as her mother stabbed her again. Hycinthia's blood cut through her mother as it balled around Hycinthia, creating a barrier between the small girl and the world. There, she

collapsed, the blood falling over the two like a blanket, no master awake to control it.

Jonathan pulled his hand over his face. He knew he needed to retire soon, but he was only halfway through his stack of letters. Complaints about the crop this year from one, a request for lumber to repair a village after the recent hurricane from the next. There were reports on his trade that he needed to tend to, and a letter from the scholar he'd hired in secret. Finally, he yawned, knowing it was time to head to bed. He knew Hycinthia was waiting for him to read her a story. She did every night, no matter how late it got. She was peculiar, but he loved her. He loved the way her eyes shone when she was tucked into bed. The way she was asleep before he'd even read a page of her book. At this point, he figured she just liked the routine more than the story, but he wouldn't trade it for the world. Often, he'd stay long after she slept, wondering what she dreamed of. Who she'd become. She curled up with her blankets and her tail and looked so truly innocent. He'd wonder how anyone could see her as a monster in these moments, how he was supposed to feel anything but love for her as her father.

He got up to turn down his lantern as his wife walked in, and bless the Architect himself, she was as beautiful as the day they'd met as the fire danced in her eyes. He cursed the Gods for what had happened to them more times than he could count, but now, he just wanted to fix it. To bring her back, to prevent the look of horror that followed their daughter whenever she crossed his wife's path, to erase the look of disgust that crossed her face when she looked at him now.

"She has horns growing on her head now"

He stared at her, letting the moment grow long, too tired to deal with another argument.

"I've noticed"

"That's it? Jonathan? That's all you have to say? You've noticed? Our daughter has a tail and horns growing from her head, and you've **noticed?**" Her words were venom now, the anger palpable in the air.

"Lorelei," He said softly, as though words could hold back her rage. This was the same fight they'd had for years. It always came to the same conclusion, and her hatred for him grew with each day.

"No. Don't try to calm me. She should've been put down when she was first born. Things like her shouldn't exist."

He sighed, "We can shave the horns down, no one will know."

"No one will know?" she scoffed. "She has a fucking tail, Jonathan."

"And we've kept it hidden. As we get older, maybe she'll have more control over it, like a limb. She'll be able to keep it around her leg in her skirts. No one will be the wiser."

"She's a monster, Jonathan. Do you understand that?" Her words echoed, yelling the words in his face now.

He took in a breath. "She's our daughter Lorelei." he said softly, trying his best to calm her.

"She's a monster."

They stared at each other for a long moment, letting the silence stretch until it became unbearable. "You will not speak of our daughter that way. She is a Seisyll, same as Percival. I would not permit either you nor him to be spoken of this way, you will not do it of our daughter."

Her voice was level now, her gaze locked on his. "If you will not do what needs to be done. I will."

The door creaked open, and he didn't need to turn to know who it was.

"Mama?" she said in a voice that broke his heart.

"Hycinthia, get out." His heart was pounding now. He didn't know what Lorelei intended to do, and he knew he could talk her down from it, but Hycinthia was not safe here right now.

"Mama?" she called again, this time through sobs. The yelling had scared her, he knew. It did every time she overheard. He crouched down to her, trying

to get her to go, wishing he could actually comfort her, wishing she hadn't been born this way.

"I'll read to you shortly, but your mother and I need you to go now. Do you understand me, Ceecee?"

"You," Lorelei said, watching their exchange, her anger boiling over, her voice completely calm. "Are nothing more than a coward." The scream that followed ripped him in two as his daughter crumpled to the ground and his wife lunged for her. He stepped over Hycinthia, taking a slash to the face as he held Lorelei back, fighting to keep her away.

"Lorelei, I'm begging you," he said, his breath shaky, "please don't do this. I'm trying to find a cure. I've been trying. She hasn't hurt anyone." Her arm twisted as she slashed his eye, blood filling his vision. He turned to grab her as she lunged, stabbing the girl again.

A blinding light rose in the forefront of the scene. For a moment the world slowed. Lorelei turned, shielding her eyes from the light. She looked at her husband's face then froze.

He stared in horror as blood rose into the air within a split second and cut into Lorelei's stomach. Her mouth twisted as blood fell out of it and she doubled over.

"I warned you she was a monster." Lorelei whispered, choking on her own blood. She crumbled to the ground, her eyes open, but they lost their focus.

"Father?" Percival asked quietly. He hid behind the door like it was his shield. Then, he turned and ran, the light following him down the corridor.

Helplessly, Jonathan watched the wall of blood move into a ball around Hycinthia and splash down on them both, feeling the warmth cover him as well. He sank to his knees as he scooped them up, holding them both. Gently, he brushed Lorelei's hair out of her face and kissed her forehead, huddling over them both as though he could keep the last few minutes from happening.

For hours, he sat there, part of his shirt now wrapped around his eye, and he just held onto them. He cradled Hycinthia and gripped Lorelei's hand, willing them both back to life. He watched their threads fade as he tried desperately to staunch their wounds. He cursed Lorelei for her gift of healing not being his own, and he swore at the gods as if they'd ever cared about him or their family.

As the sun rose over their bodies, Hycinthia stirred. Barely. She curled in on her wounds as he noticed her blood fresh in the wraps. Carefully, he undid them, rewrapping her stomach and her arm, trying to keep the blood at bay, trying to keep her alive.

Age Four.

Hycinthia wandered the halls alone, spots of blood seeping from her bandages, leaving a trail behind her. The other cuts had healed, scars covering her body, but two hadn't. They remained as fresh as the day she got them, and the pain had left her in tears. She sobbed now, calling for her mother, searching for her. She wandered to her father's study and climbed into his lap, cuddling into his arms and crying for her mother. The pain wouldn't go away, and eventually, her father carried her into her room to rewrap her bandages. He gave her some medicine, and she was asleep again, nestled in her bed, as more blood steadily seeped through.

Age Five.

He watched her as she played in the garden, finding a frog that had captivated her attention. She picked it up, tottering towards him, her perpetual trail of blood following behind. He didn't know why his father insisted he watch her. Why he insisted he kept the **thing** safe. The girl adored him and followed him everywhere. Like siblings are supposed to. But he hated her for it.

"Percy, Percy!" Hycinthia squealed, holding the frog close. She cracked her two small hands, peeking inside to make sure he was real.

"Percy! I got a fog!" She thrust her hands toward him, wanting him to see it. She had a toothy grin, proud of her work. "Is simmyyyy"

He stiffened as she moved her arms quickly, still not able to wipe the night his mother died from his memory, unable to erase watching his mother crumble to the ground. "Yes- Hycinthia- it's a **frog**"

"Has what i aid! A fog!!." She smiled up at him. "Can we sow mama?" He glared at her.

"She's gone, Hycinthia. How many times do you have to be told this?"

She looked up at him, her eyes wide, confused. "Where see go? When will see be back?" She held the frog gently now, still excited, but her mood was tempered now.

"Why do you keep doing this? You know what you've done don't you?"

Hycinthia's head tilted to the side, her tail twitching on its own. "When is mama coming home?"

"She's not coming home." He snapped at her.

She whimpered, coming closer to him, wanting to hug him in his anger. He shoved her back, and she stumbled, sobbing.

"She's dead, you killed her, you killed her. And every day you ask for her."

"I-" she clutched the frog to protect him from her fall.

"She's dead. She's dead."

Her sobs filled the air, a pained sound, but he doubted it was about their mother. He turned and walked away. He couldn't hear her cries, couldn't absorb them as his own head clouded. He wiped his own tears away as he took off running for his room, for the last place he'd seen his mother when she was alive. The last time he'd seen her smile. He clutched a blanket on his bed, the last thing that still smelled like her.

Age Seven.

Hyacinth lay curled on the floor next to her door. She had been banging for hours but it seemed no one could hear her- or they didn't care.

"Father? Please," she called out again.

Age Ten.

"No one ever explained to me what death was."

She sat there on his bed, her arm slung around one knee, eyes boring into him.

"What?" He stepped into the room cautiously.

"You hate me. I know this. But you never stopped to wonder if I hated you." She spoke confidently, like this conversation had been rehearsed in her head. It was so unlike how she usually spoke now.

"I assumed you did."

"I didn't until today." She shuddered, like her words carried a weight that she fought to hold back. "I never understood. Because no one ever told me. I know Mom got sick, I know she died, but no one ever told me what that meant. I was a child; I longed for my mother, same as you. But no one ever told me what it meant for her to be dead.

"I don't remember her sickness, I don't remember her dying, Percy." She took a long breath.

"Do you want to know how I learned what death was?"

Percival nodded slowly, almost in shock by how direct his shy sister was being. He had been caught off guard by what she had to say, and a pit formed in his stomach. How had he learned what death was? It felt like something he'd always known, a fact like the sky being blue. He never realized the girl who had killed their mother didn't know its weight.

"Yesterday, when we attended the hanging. When I heard the words 'hang till dead' and then I watched the life leave his eyes. That. That is when I knew our mother was **dead**

"For that, I hate you. For leaving me in my confusion, waiting for a mother who you knew would never come back. I don't know what I did to make you hate me, but I hate you now, so I guess that makes us even?"

He could hear the plea in her voice, like a part of her didn't want to hate him. Like she hoped that her words would fix what was broken between them.

They couldn't. Nothing would ever erase the memory of his mother as she lay in a pool of her own blood. Nothing would erase the four-year-old who used her blood as a spear.

He watched as she breathed in deeply, slowly letting the air back out. She looked calm, but he noticed her tail twitched wildly behind her. It always betrayed her emotions, moving faster the more nervous or scared she felt. He sighed and sat down on the bed with her. In that moment, he saw the girl who hid behind him in tears as their parents' yelling echoed throughout the house.

"I don't hate you," he whispered. It wasn't true, not really, but he wanted it to be.

She broke into sobs, curling into herself, like she'd wanted someone to tell her those exact words her entire life. Awkwardly, he put an arm around her. She flinched back as though his touch stung. Maybe it had. When was the last time someone had given her a hug? The two sat there as she cried until eventually she fell asleep, just like she had as a kid. Gently, he pulled his blanket over her and fell asleep too. For the first time, he realized just how much he missed his little sister.

Age Eleven.

She sat on the beach alone. Her legs were tucked beneath her, and she slowly unwrapped her arm from its bandage. The pain barely bothered her anymore, and she had found ways to keep the wounds from leaking. It was her Affinity, her father had called it. She could manipulate its flow. Mostly, it just made her brother look at her in horror, and her father pretend it didn't exist. She knew affinities usually had a **moment** when they began, but she couldn't remember hers. No one would tell her. So, she sat alone, waiting for the tide to rise enough that no evidence would be left when she was done, and she focused on her threads. She lifted the blood out of her arm, wincing. This part hurt more than her cuts now, but she watched with satisfaction as a small bead appeared, floating in front of her. Then it burst. She grumbled in frustration as she focused harder, pulling more blood from her body. For hours, she sat there, moving occasionally when the waves climbed higher until, eventually, she collapsed in the sand, blacking out from the blood loss.

She woke up to her brother wrapping her arm, and she smiled at him.

"You have to stop doing this." Her smile widened a little. There was a time when he wouldn't speak to her at all, but recently, he'd been writing her letters when he was away at school. They were infrequent, but it was more than he had in the past. She wasn't sure what changed, but she hoped they'd be friends someday.

Her father said he'd shut her off because when she was younger, she'd cry for their mother. Every time she'd been told Lorelei died, it had never seemed to stick in her memory. She'd go up to Percy and ask where she was, and he'd hated her for the constant reminders of their loss. She couldn't remember anything from those years, and was troubled by the gaps in her memories, but she didn't know who to ask for answers. Her father only yelled and raged. Everything set him off, and he'd spend hours angry, whether it was because of her studies or how their meal had been cooked. She remembered stories, but those memories didn't fit the man he was, and sometimes she wondered if it had never been him entirely.

"How else will I get better at it?"

He looked at her aghast. "Get better at what?"

"My affinity- surely it's useful for something other than just- keeping my blood inside my body." She laughed a little, but he didn't seem to find the same humor in it.

"It's wrong- if anyone caught you-"

"Percy, if anyone caught me literally existing, I'd be in trouble."

"That's not what I meant, you cannot just pretend this is ok. Your affinity is evil. I don't understand why you insist on practicing it. You cannot keep all of this hidden forever. What will you do when someone finally figures it out?"

"I'm not even allowed to leave the manor, can't you see that? Who would figure it out? I've tried, I've begged, to be able to go to town, to just leave these walls. Father yells every time. He smacked me last time I was caught at the beach, and no one even goes there. It's ours, who would've seen?"

He just shook his head and left, not bothering to reply. Who cared? He would be gone in a week.

Age Fourteen.

"You're drunk."

"And?" He leaned against the wall, staring at the ceiling, refusing to meet her gaze.

"Percy, you cannot keep doing this."

"Why ever not?"

"Because, you come home, get drunk, then fight with father, and drink mor. It's the same pattern every time. I don't want to keep watching you self distr

Age Fifteen.

She stood quietly as her father threw a chair against the door. Her arm was unwrapped, as she'd been caught again at the beach, but for once that wasn't why her father was angry.

"He's really not coming back?" Her voice was small. She wanted to cry, but refused to in front of her father.

He turned on her in rage. "This is your fault. It's always your fault." He yanked her by her arm, and she winced as pain shot through it. "You and your cursed affinity, your hellish existence." He shoved her, letting her stumble backward.

"I should've done as the law required years ago, should've let you die as a child. Why do you take everything I love from me?"

"You loved me." she said it as a plea, but it only came out in a whisper. He turned toward her, angry, and reached to grab her again. To pull her arm and make her suffer again. Reflexively, she stepped back and tugged on the thread in it, pulling her blood in front of her, the ribbon of liquid glistening between them. He stumbled back in fear as she quickly let it drop, moving further away from him. She hadn't meant to pull on the thread; she hadn't meant to use her abilities at all. She just wanted Percy back. And he'd left her alone. Again. But this time, he wasn't coming home. She turned and ran out of the room, not letting him regain his composure.

Age Sixteen.

There was a knock on her door. She was sitting on the floor, her blood snaking in the air, hovering like a circlet around her. She was practicing putting the blood **back in her body** after using it.

The door opened fully as her father stepped in, not even glancing at his daughter or the slowly shrinking ribbon. He hated looking at her, hated the reminder of his wife that she now resembled so closely. Her tail was always perfectly hidden now, and there were days he could forget what she was. Then, there were days like today, when he saw her and the witchcraft she could perform. He was angry she didn't even try to hide it from him anymore, like she wanted to force him into accepting her.

"I've come to a decision," He said, finally forcing her to look up at him, breaking the concentration she had. The blood fell around her, making a circle, but she barely even noticed.

"Since you're the only heir I have now, as your brother has shirked his duties completely, you're going to learn how to run this house to take it over one day. You will take on all the duties he had, and you will begin attending formal events with me as my daughter until you are capable enough to attend on your own as my representative."

She perked up excitedly, but he left the room before she could reply, leaving her dismissed and alone again.

Age Sixteen.

She scrambled around her room getting ready, nearly knocking over her bottle of powder.

"No no no-" She lunged for it, setting it safely back on her vanity. "stupid tail," she muttered, holding it and moving to pull more bandages out of her drawer. Carefully, she wrapped her tail around her leg, securing it with bandages so it would stay in place. Yanking on her dress, she spun toward the mirror to make sure everything was in place. She scrutinized her now blonde hair and its braids. She'd spent all morning braiding it and filling it with pins.

Age Eighteen.

She coughed up water on the beach, choking on the air. Rolling over, she puked. Hycinthia couldn't remember what she'd eaten for dinner, but now regretted whatever it had been. Slowly, she dragged herself to her knees, trying to assess what injuries she might have. A shard of wood stabbed through her calf, jutting from her now ragged pants. Looking around, she noticed people on the shore, some loitering, but none coming near her yet. She felt her leg for the bandages secured there and repositioned them, assuring that they'd stay in place. Her sleeve was torn, the bandages coming loose around her cut. These were all future problems; she couldn't pull on her threads to fix them here.

She tried to recall what had happened. There was a ship, she knew. She had boarded it to finalize the exchange of fruit tree saplings for the glass vases her father was known for selling, with a nobleman in Overshire. Hycinthia closed her eyes, willing herself to remember. This would not be another memory lost in her tangled mess of a life. She closed her eyes and counted her breaths, pulling in slowly. There was no memory of how she'd learned to calm herself down, but it had always worked. One. Two. Three. Four. Five. and out.

She closed her eyes and did her best to picture the night before. There was a light. Percy? No, he hadn't been there. Hycinthia had forgotten how long it had been since she saw him last. She latched onto the light in her memory as it began to flicker and form into a candle waxed down to the desk. Papers were strewn about and for the moment, she was transported into her cabin. The ship swayed beneath her, the motion in her memory as tangible as though it were happening in Hycinthia's present. The flame flickered brighter, rocking with the ship. Then she heard screams. Her body shook as she opened her eyes on the beach, the memories shoving her out.

"No!" Hycinthia screamed, clutching her hands to her ears in pain. Tears welled in her eyes as she shook. She pulled her knees to her chest, trying to breathe in again. She couldn't stay on the beach. What happened that night? Who owned the screams? Had she gone out of her room and joined the chaos? Where was the rest of the ship? One. Two. What had she been doing that night?

No. One. Had Percy been with her? Is that why she thought of him? One. No. One. Two. No. One. No, Breathe. One. Two. Three. Three. Four. Five. Out. One. Two. Three. Four. Five. In. Count. Out. In Out.

The shaking subsided. She counted once more, putting her hands on her knees, preparing to pull herself up from the sand.

"You alright, Miss?" A boy crouched down, his arm extended to help her up. She pushed herself up, standing to meet him instead.

"I- uh- yeah." She resisted the urge to dust off her pants. *I need to make eye contact- right?* "Umm- thank you-"

She started walking away from him, not waiting for a reply. Scrambling, the boy stepped into pace beside her.

"Wait- Miss, I never caught your name." He looks her over again. "Shit, are you sure you're alright? You're bleeding, we need to get you to a healer."

"I am one. I'm fine"

"At least let me walk you home?"

She stops and looks at him, contemplating what to say. What was she supposed to say? "Where are we?"

"Overshire-" He shakes his head.

The Sibling Letters

The Misha Letters

Misha,

This is probably dumb. We've danced a few times, and- I was wondering if you'd want to start a correspondence? I ~~enjoy~~ look forward to seeing you at the balls. Something about you just- makes me happy.

Misha,

You opened up to me today, and- I don't think I had the correct words to say. We sat in silence as I fumbled for the correct words to say. "I'm sorry," but that wasn't right. Those weren't the words I wanted to say. I wanted to say I know what it's like to be raised as someone else.

Six months after shipwreck

Misha,

I know I've never sent you a letter before, but now feels too important to not. You're my best friend. Hell, you're the only person I can confidently say I love without hesitation at the thought. I'm sorry I have taken this long to write, and I understand if you're angry with me for waiting. I needed to make sure no one would try to come find me, that everyone at home believed I was dead. I don't know how much I will be able to write after this, but you mean too much to me for me to not try. I will miss how you made the world disappear when I was in your presence, how you made my fears seem small. There are things I need to tell you that I never had the courage to before. I'm sorry for being a coward. One day, I promise I will explain everything. I miss you.

-C